Zhuoyu (Rachel) Qiu

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Research Interests

My research is in applied microeconomics, specializing labor economics and the economics of education. I use causal inference methods with large-scale administrative and survey data. My current work examines how family and educational environments shape human capital accumulation, child well-being, and gender disparities.

Education

- **University of California, Riverside** — Riverside, CA, USA
  Ph.D. in Economics — *Sep. 2021 – Jun. 2027 (expected)*
- **Jinan University** — Guangzhou, China
  M.S. in Economics, with Honors — *Sep. 2019 – Jun. 2021*
- **Zhongnan University of Economics and Law** — Wuhan, China
  B.S. in Economics, with Honors — *Sep. 2014 – Jun. 2019*

Job Market Paper

- **Gender Peer Effects and Women's Academic Performance in Mathematics: Evidence from a U.S. University [Link]**

Abstract: Understanding women's progress in mathematics can help explain their continued underrepresentation in mathematics-intensive fields. Using administrative records from a U.S. university, I exploit variation in female peer share across classes in a specific introductory mathematics course taught by a given instructor within an academic term. A 10-percentage-point (pp) increase in female peer share raises women's mathematics completion probability by 3.1 pp; on average, exposure to 10 more female classmates leads to about 1.4 additional completions among women per class. Women's benefits are concentrated among those entering with a declared STEM major, while both genders experience broader first-term academic gains. Longer-term results provide suggestive evidence of increased STEM degree attainment among women entering with a declared STEM major.

Publication

[1] Punching Out, Not Down: The Impact of Paid Sick Leave on Child Maltreatment. **Qiu, Z.** *Labour Economics, 2026*, 102958. [**Link**]

Selected Work in Progress

- **Effects of Faculty Gender Attitudes on College Students' Short- and Long-Term Outcomes**

With Radhika Bansal (University of California, Riverside), Ozkan Eren (University of California, Riverside), Krzysztof Karbownik (Emory University), and Ruinan Zhao (State of California Department of Industrial Relations)

  - Link university records (2013–2024) with faculty Gender-Science Implicit Association Test responses to study student achievement, major choice, graduation, and earnings.
  - Preliminary findings associate stronger instructor gender bias with female students leaving their declared majors and a lower likelihood of on-time graduation.

- **The Impact of Marriage Tax Bonus and Penalty on Marital Decisions in the U.S.**

With Zhe Yang (Liaoning University)

  - Use SIPP data and an instrumental-variable strategy based on state and demographic variation to estimate how marriage tax incentives affect marriage formation and dissolution.
  - A 1% increase in the marriage-bonus-to-income ratio increases cohabiting couples' likelihood of marriage by 0.12%.

Technical and Policy Reports

[1] The State of Work in the Inland Empire Part II: Pandemic, Polarization, Inflation, and Investment. Bates, M., Bruene, S., Calderon, E. E., De La Torre, E., Freire, P., Guo, J., Hutchins, G. B., Jackson, K., Kapoor, M., Nelson, F., **Qiu, Z.**, Reese, E., Rettberg, G., and Tamayose, B. C. *Inland Empire Labor and Community Center and Center for Social Innovation, University of California, Riverside, 2023*. [**Link**]

Technical and Policy Reports (continued)

[2] The State of Work: Transportation, Distribution, and Logistics in the Inland Empire. Bainiwal, T. S., Bates, M., Brookes, M., Bruene, S., Calderon, E., Carranza, N., De La Torre, E., Freire, P., Gudis, C., Guo, J., Hutchins, G. B., Jackson, K., Kapoor, M., Nelson, F., **Qiu, Z.**, Reese, E., Rettberg, G., Tamayose, B., and Tan, A. *Inland Empire Labor and Community Center and Center for Social Innovation, University of California, Riverside, 2024*. [**Link**]

[3] Thrive Inland SoCal: Labor Market Analysis. Bates, M., Brookes, M., Bruene, S., Burnett, J., Calderon, E., Carbajal, A., De La Torre, E., Guo, J., Hutchins, G. B., Kapoor, M., Mukenge, K., Nelson, F., **Qiu, Z.**, Rana, S., Reese, E., Rettberg, G., Salam, I., and Tamayose, B. *Inland Empire Labor and Community Center and Center for Social Innovation, University of California, Riverside, 2024*. [**Link**]

Teaching Experience

- **University of California, Riverside** — Riverside, CA, USA

*Instructor of Record (avg.: **4.78/5**)* — *Aug. 2025*

- Urban Economics *(Sum. 2025)*

*Teaching Assistant (avg.: **6.56/7** for sections w/ enroll. >10 & resp. rate > campus avg.)* — *Oct. 2022 – Present*

- Introductory Econometrics *(F. 2022; W. 2023; W. & F. 2024; W., Spr., & F. 2025; W. 2026)*
- Statistics for Economics *(F. 2023)*
- Intermediate Microeconomic Theory *(Spr. 2024; Spr. 2026)*

Software Instructor — *Jul. – Aug. 2023*

- Stata Boot Camp, Master of Public Policy Program

Pedagogical Training — *Jul. 2026*

- Summer Curriculum Design Institute

Research Experience

- **Department of Economics, University of California, Riverside**
  for Prof. Veronica Sovero, Graduate Student Researcher — *Jul. – Sep. 2026*
- **Center for Social Innovation, University of California, Riverside**
  Graduate Student Researcher — *Apr. – Jun. 2023*
- **Peking University HSBC Business School**
  for Prof. Yizhen Gu, Research Assistant — *Dec. 2020 – Jun. 2021*
- **Guangzhou Academy of Social Sciences**
  Research Assistant — *Aug. – Dec. 2020*

Presentations and Talks

- Economic Seminar Series, California State University Long Beach *(scheduled)* — *2026*
- Southern Economic Association (SEA) 96th Annual Meeting *(department nominated, scheduled)* — *2026*
- International Symposium on Contemporary Labor Economics, Xiamen University — *2025*
- Southern Economic Association (SEA) 95th Annual Meeting — *2025*
- Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Annual Fall Conference — *2025*
- 18th All-California Labor Economics Conference–Poster Session, Stanford University — *2025*
- China Economics Society (CES) China Annual Conference, Sun Yat-sen University — *2025*
- SEMi-Talk Academic Workshop, Tsinghua University — *2024*
- 15th All-California Labor Economics Conference–Poster Session, University of California, Riverside — *2022*

Referee Service

- Journal of Labor Research

Honors and Awards

- Dean's Distinguished Fellowship, University of California, Riverside — *2021 – Present*
- Outstanding Graduate Award, Jinan University — *2019 – 2021*

Skills

Software: Stata, Python, MATLAB, R, SQL, LaTeX, Qualtrics

Additional Skills: Policy report writing, survey design, data visualization

Language: English (proficient), Mandarin (native), Cantonese (native), Hakka (fluent)

References

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